

ADAM EDUARD ANTHONY UPENIEKS

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Financial markets, asset pricing, news & market efficiency.

EDUCATION

University of Calgary, Canada PhD in Finance	2021–present
Bayes Business School, London, UK MSc in Quantitative Finance — With Distinction (First-Class Honours, GPA 4.0)	2019–2020
University of Waterloo, Waterloo, Canada MA in Economics	2017–2019
University of Waterloo, Waterloo, Canada BA in Economics	2012–2017

WORKING PAPERS

Looking Away from the Market *Job Market Paper, sole-authored*

The Capital Asset Pricing Model (CAPM) is rejected empirically because market beta is weakly related to average returns. This paper shows that the performance of the CAPM depends on where institutional investors concentrate their attention. Using firm-specific news from the Dow Jones Newswire and institutional attention measures from Bloomberg search activity, I isolate states in which market-wide attention is focused on publicly available firm-level news. In these states the CAPM prices risk even though overall attention is lower: betas explain the cross section of returns and the security market line is steep and positive. When attention is instead elevated but not well explained by firm-specific news, the beta–return relation flattens or reverses. To rationalize these findings, I develop a general equilibrium model in which investors allocate attention between firm-specific public news and direct signals about the aggregate factor. Because attention to firm-specific news crowds out private learning about the common factor, it raises posterior factor uncertainty, for which investors demand compensation—generating a higher equilibrium factor risk premium and a steeper security market line. Empirically, unconditional betas price returns on approximately 46% of trading days.

Beta Between the Headlines *sole-authored*
Revise and resubmit, Review of Asset Pricing Studies

The empirical security market line is far too flat relative to the CAPM. I show that this flatness reflects biased beliefs: firms exposed to the long or short side of many anomalies are mispriced, and the mispricing is distributed asymmetrically across beta-sorted portfolios. Idiosyncratic news corrects this mispricing in the direction of a flatter security market line, so beta is strongly and positively priced when idiosyncratic news is scarce.

Presented at: FMA Asia/Pacific*, Alpine Finance Summit 2026* (poster), Southern Finance Association 2026*, European Financial Management Association 2026, French Finance Association 2026, Future Finance Festival, Global Finance Conference 2026, Financial Management and Accounting Research Conference 2026 (* scheduled).

Overreaction to Scarcity: Precautionary Demand and Oil Price Reversals *with Alexander David*

Text-based measures of attention to oil demand and supply in the financial press negatively predict crude oil futures returns over the following year while pushing analyst forecasts up—the signature of belief overreaction. Using a two-stage large language model pipeline to decompose the EIA’s Short-Term Energy Outlook into structural channels, we show that expectations about future scarcity, rather than realized demand or supply, drive the oil price movements that later reverse.

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2026: Université de Sherbrooke (research seminar), Alpine Finance Summit (invited discussant)

HONORS & AWARDS

Marion and Janet Forbes Scholarship (\$16,000) 2026

Alberta Graduate Excellence Scholarship (\$11,000), University of Calgary

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor — Haskayne School of Business 2024

BA — Futures and Options (FNCE 445), student rating 4.6/5

Teaching Assistant — Haskayne School of Business 2021–2024

- PhD — Empirical Corporate Finance (FNCE 775, Prof. Pablo Moran)
- DBA — Empirical Methods (MGST 772, Prof. Pablo Moran)
- MBA — Advanced Topics in Corporate Finance (FNCE 661, Prof. Ari Pandes)
- BA — Futures and Options (FNCE 445, Prof. KJ Choi)
- BA — Investments (FNCE 443, Prof. Miguel Palacios)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Hiring Committee Member

Assistant Professor in Quantum Finance, Haskayne School of Business 2025

Teaching Professor in Finance, Haskayne School of Business 2024

Referee

FMA Asia/Pacific Conference

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Ontario Ministry of Finance — Financial Risk Analyst, Toronto, Canada 2018–2019

Universität Hamburg — Research Intern (Vensim), Hamburg, Germany 2017–2018

CODING & SOFTWARE SKILLS

Strong: Python, Mathematica

Experienced: MATLAB, Stata, OxMetrics, Vensim, Dynare, R

MISCELLANEOUS

- Cordon Bleu — Certificate in Pastry Baking, Paris, France (2019)
- Rowing — Head of the Charles Regatta, 14/28, Boston, United States (2015)
- Running — San Francisco Marathon, 358/822, United States (2025)

REFERENCES

Prof. Miguel Palacios (Supervisor)

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Prof. Alexander David (Co-supervisor)

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Prof. Charles Martineau

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